

**AUSTRALIAN JUNIOR CHESS PROBLEM-SOLVING CHAMPIONSHIP
GOLD COAST, 22 January 2013**

Report by Nigel Nettheim
nettheim (at) bigpond.net.au



Solving in progress. This shows only a small portion of the large hall.
Some invigilators are seen in the background.

1. This was the seventh year of the problem-solving event, following Canberra 2007, Sydney 2008, Adelaide 2009, Hobart 2010, Melbourne 2011 and Melbourne 2012. Reports on earlier events can be seen via <http://OzProblems.com>.
2. A single paper was set for all ages, prizes then being awarded for the open and girls groups U8, U10, U12, U14, U16 and U18. The list of prize-winners is available on the Championship web site at <http://www.gardinerchess.com/ausjuniors2013/allresults.htm>. Trophies and cash prizes were presented. The numbers of solvers are shown in Table 1. The total number of solvers was 76 (compared with 81 in 2012 and 77 in 2011), competing well with the local Dreamworld attraction.
3. Each solver was provided with a board and men.
4. The time taken was noted when each question sheet was returned, to be used if necessary to break ties. Few competitors left particularly early, most staying for the whole two hours. It should perhaps be announced that leaving early is quite OK, which might be different from school exams.

5. The question sheets and the solutions are included at the end of this file. I also have spare hard-copies that may be requested.

6. My article entitled “A Quick Introduction to Chess Problems and End-game Studies”, which I had originally prepared for the 2007 Championship, was made available on the present Championship’s web site. The article is of some value in making sure that all competitors know in advance what problems and studies are, and that they have been exposed to a suitable introduction to them, with examples. Before solving started I also explained what “Mate in 2 moves” means, because not all entrants may have been familiar with the term.

7. The format of the question sheet continues to work well: a single A3 sheet folded over to take up A4 size, with only the instructions on the front page so that the sheet could be placed unopened on the tables in advance.

8. During the solving period, Jim Ritchie, Toby Davies and Matt Gilpin kindly joined me as invigilators and were available to answer questions from the competitors. Only a few questions were asked.

9. Marking was carried out by myself, with further checking by Ian Rogers in cases where the results were close. No ties resulted, so the solving times did not need to be used.

10. The markers’ job is assumed to be finished when the total marks have been reported in each of the 12 birth-year/gender sections. Then the tournament organizers apply a method of determining prizes according to their desired scheme. The markers have a role to play in breaking any ties and in recommending any special awards.

11. Very many thanks indeed are offered to Geoff Foster for once again carrying out the time-consuming expert job of setting the tasks and preparing the papers and solutions for printing. I collaborated by proposing studies and solving the tasks.

12. The general impression from their comments was that competitors enjoyed the event. The administrators also seemed very satisfied with it. It has been reported that parents like the “examination” atmosphere of the event, making it seem somewhat similar to a school exam and thus suggesting that chess is not just a matter of their children playing games – an unforeseen favourable effect. Gary Lane made the point that most juniors do not continue playing chess after their school days, and problem-solving has a value in providing a chess activity that they can carry with them into the future.

13. Again the influence of coaches in promoting problem-solving was noticeable, and is to be encouraged. Coaches could explain that under-promotion and stalemate arise more often in problems and studies than in chess games. However, this year’s open winner Matthew Pyper confessed that he does not solve problems during the year – he clearly has a special knack for these events, having also won the U12 prize in 2009. Even composition has occasionally been attempted by juniors, and is a long-term goal of the solving activity.

14. As always, our policy has been not to release individual results. The reasons for this include the following: (i) No disparagement was ever intended towards those scoring low marks, especially as some may never have seen a formal problem or endgame study before. (ii) Requests for revision might lead to prolonged correspondence for which there simply isn’t time, and the marking has already been done with all care (see paragraph 9). (iii) In

cases where it was already clear that prizes would not be affected, less attention might be given to the awarding of partial credit or the resolving of small differences between markers, as a purely practical matter. (iv) The marks scored have meaning only in relation to the particular tasks set and their difficulty, so that comparisons from year to year, or to school-work exams, would not be valid.

15. A table of marks awarded for each task is not given this year, but instead a summary in Table 2. Averaged over all ages, boys did better than girls this year, though not last year. When setting the tasks it is desired that the marks be not too low, so that solvers get some satisfaction from their efforts, and that was achieved fairly well, although a somewhat easier paper seems indicated for next year. On the other hand, some difficult tasks are needed in an attempt to separate the best solvers. The top few solvers were the only ones to do well in the last three tasks, so that function was served. The progression of difficulty through the three pages of questions was about as expected (statistics not shown here).

16. Brief comments will now be made on each of the fifteen tasks:

1. Each year we attempt to provide a “gift”, so that everyone gets some satisfaction, bearing in mind that some solvers are very young; this one, with wonderful simplicity and yet by a famous composer, suited the purpose well.
2. This was intended as a “near-gift” and was well solved.
3. Another simple task by the same composer as No. 1.
4. The “quiz” format worked well here.
5. This was better solved than the surrounding tasks, the main tries being 1.Qc7 and 1.Bxa5.
6. At this stage a little more subtlety is appearing. 1.Kc4 was a popular try.
7. It is not easy to see the refutation of 1.Qf1, and 3 marks of partial credit were given for it. A popular try was 1.Nf6+, overlooking the fact that White would next be in check.
8. The difficulty is increasing steadily, but quite a few solvers found the under-promotion to a B.
9. For the first time we included a proof game, which was popular and very well solved, a good deal better than the surrounding tasks.
10. This is now fairly sophisticated, and the success rate dropped off considerably.
11. Now the success rate dropped off further; this one requires awareness of the Rs’ actions along the ranks.
12. A quite difficult mate in 2 because of the three good tries, all with the WQ moving on its rank. No. 11 and 12 were found about equally difficult.
13. The idea of retreating with the WK was quite well-hidden and not found by many. The BB has the whole long diagonal at its disposal, but it can still be caught.
14. A difficult mate in 3 intended to help determine a winner among the top solvers. The triangular scheme with the WQ is quite well-hidden; once it is seen, the WN has to avoid all the lines needed by the WQ, and there is only one square (an unlikely-looking one) that does the job.
15. The last task was most likely the hardest, especially finding the clever 8.Be5! near the end of the line. Only the winner succeeded here, though the runner-up made a good attempt. In fact the winner succeeded with the three last tasks, and was the only solver to do so.

Best wishes for the future!

Nigel Nettheim, 9 June 2013.

Table 1. Number of Competitors, in each Birth-year Group and each Gender

Birth year	2005-	2003- 2004	2001- 2002	1999- 2000	1997- 1998	1995- 1996	Total
Boys	2	13	22	13	8	4	62
Girls	1	4	4	2	3	0	14
Total	3	17	26	15	11	4	76

Table 2. Average Marks/150, in each Birth-year Group and each Gender

Birth year	2005-	2003- 2004	2001- 2002	1999- 2000	1997- 1998	1995- 1996	All
Boys	29.5	36.0	46.4	56.5	71.1	76.5	50.9
Girls	9.0	13.3	22.8	49.5	39.3	-	26.4
All	22.7	30.7	42.8	55.5	62.5	76.5	46.4

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NAME: _____

AGE GROUP (circle): **U8** **U10** **U12** **U14** **U16** **U18**

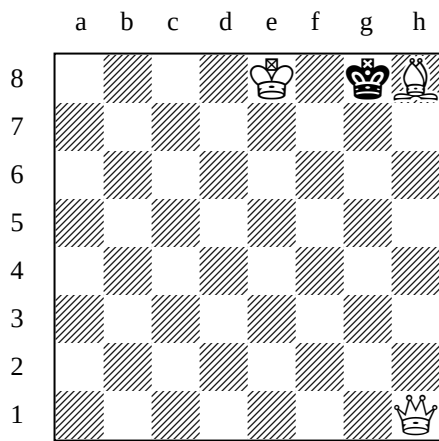
GENDER (circle): **BOY** **GIRL**

In all diagrams White is playing up the board. All tasks are worth equal marks. They are ordered according to estimated difficulty, easiest first. It is recommended to start at the beginning and work through in approximate order.

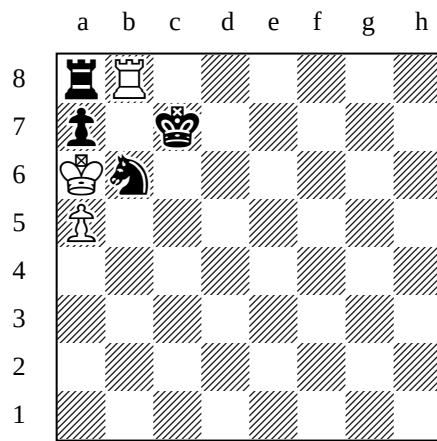
Please write your solution in the space provided near the diagram. For 2-move problems, just give White's first move. For the 3-move problem, give up to White's 2nd move. For studies, just go far enough to reach a clearly winning, or drawing, position, without giving minor details.

Solve as many tasks as you can, but there is no expectation that you will solve them all! As a guide, those who are young or new to solving might expect to do well on the first page, tasks 1-5; more experienced solvers might do well also on the second page, thus tasks 1-10; experts might also succeed with some on the last page. But there are no restrictions: anyone may attempt any of the tasks, and everyone, including experts, should start at the beginning.

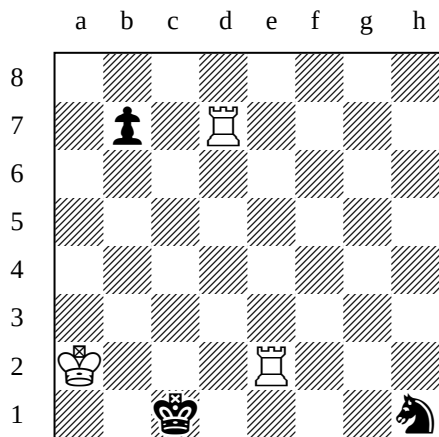
An answer sheet will be available at the end of the solving period.



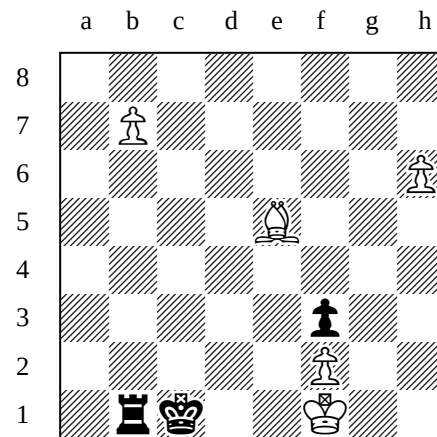
1) White to play and mate in 2 moves



2) White to play and Win



3) White to play and mate in 2 moves

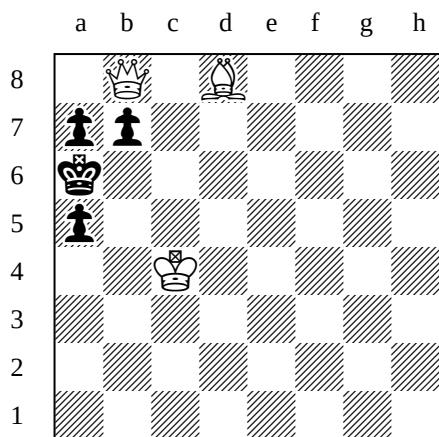


4) White to play and Win

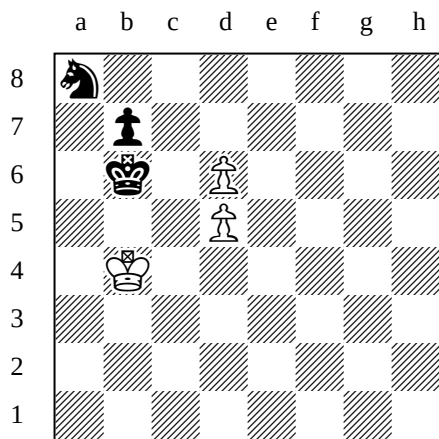
A) How would the game finish after 1.b8=Q?

1.b8=Q _____ 2. _____

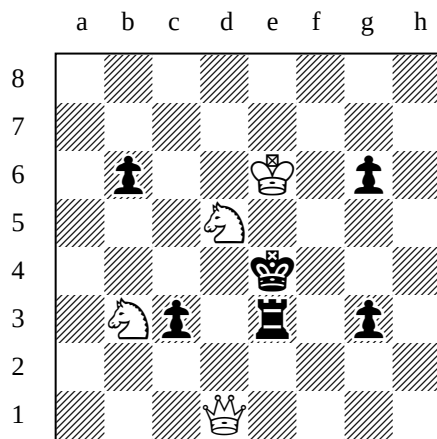
B) What is White's winning move? 1. _____



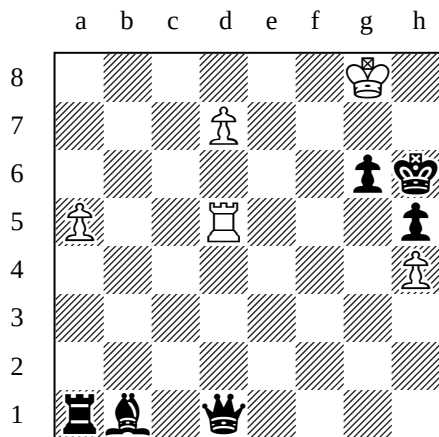
5) White to play and mate in 2 moves



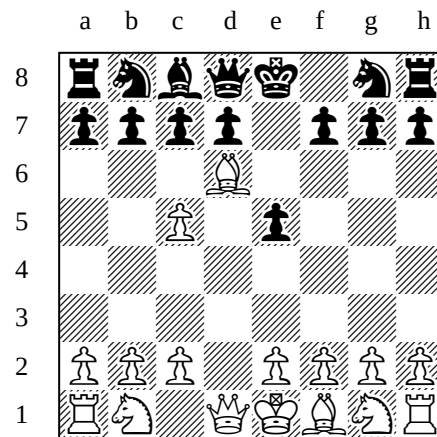
6) White to play and Win



7) White to play and mate in 2 moves

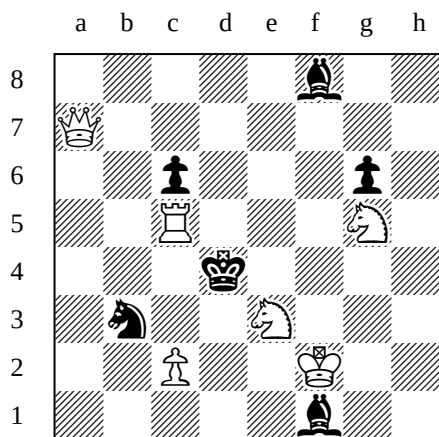


8) White to play and Draw

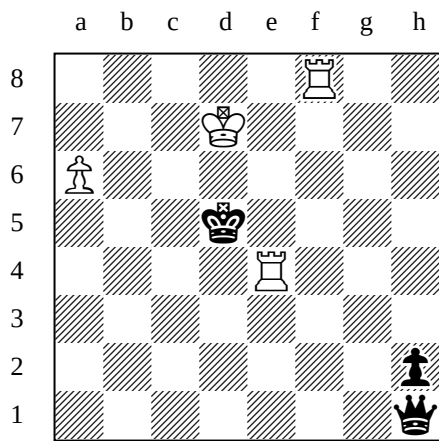


9) This position arose after Black's 4th move in a legal (but unusual!) game of chess. What were the moves?

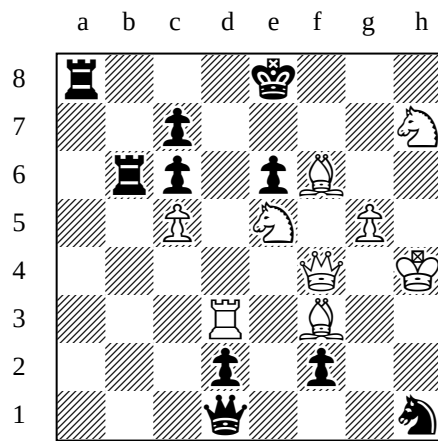
1. _____ 2. _____
3. _____ 4. _____



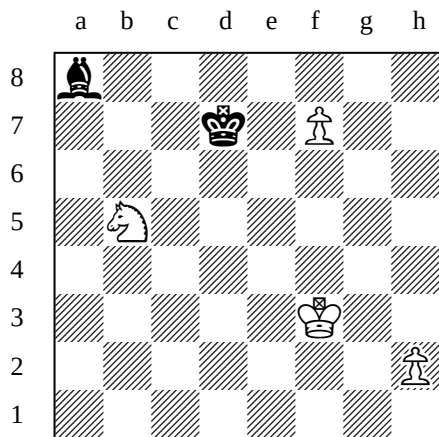
10) White to play and mate in 2 moves



11) White to play and Win

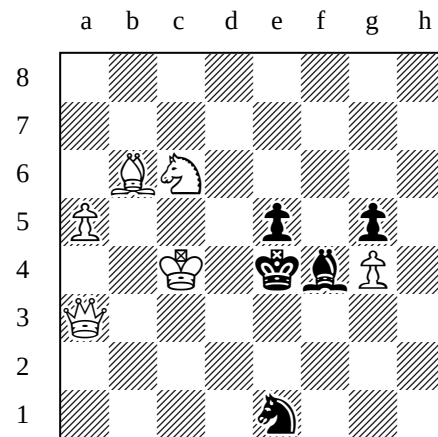


12) White to play and mate in 2 moves



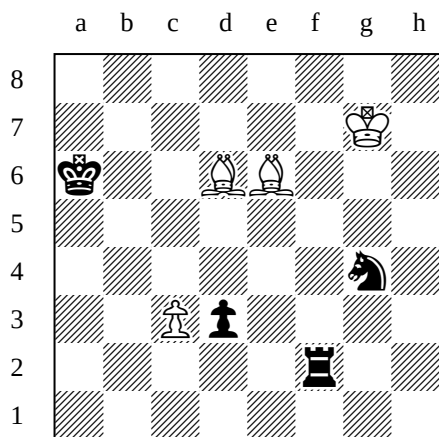
13) White to play and Win

Note: There is no need to show that K+N+P v K wins here.



14) White to play and mate in 3 moves

Note: Show up to White's 2nd move.

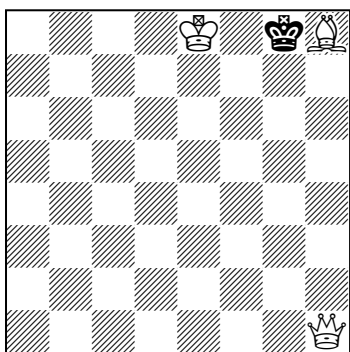


15) White to play and Draw

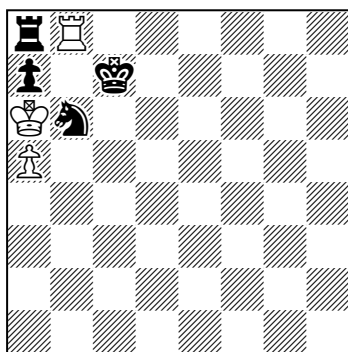
Notes: Assume K+B+B v K+R+N draws in general. Assume K+B v K+R draws in general. It is enough to give the main line.

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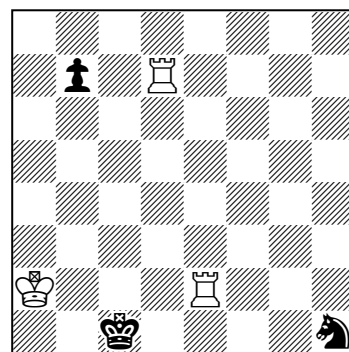
SOLUTIONS



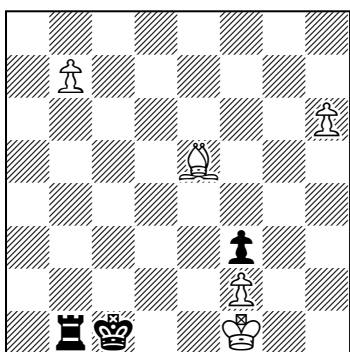
1) Mate in 2
1.Qa1! Kh7 2.Qg7#



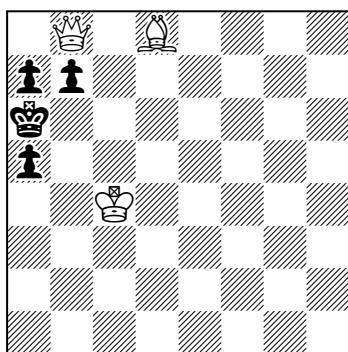
2) Win
1.axb6+ Kxb8 2.b7 Kc7
3.bxa8=Q.



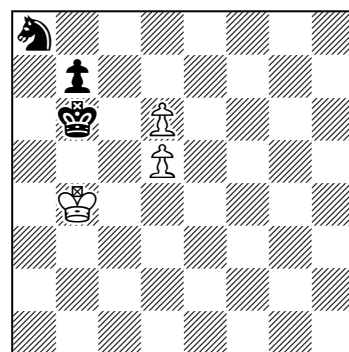
3) Mate in 2
1.Re8! Kc2 2.Rc8#



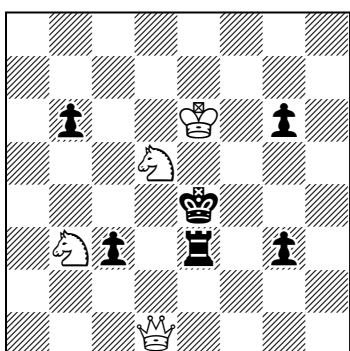
4) Win
A) 1.b8=Q? Kd2+ 2.Qxb1 stalemate.
B) 1.b8=R!



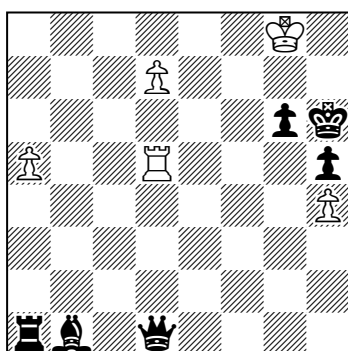
5) Mate in 2
1.Bb6! (threat 2.Qxa7)
1. ... Kxb6 2.Qd6
1. ... axb6 2.Qa8



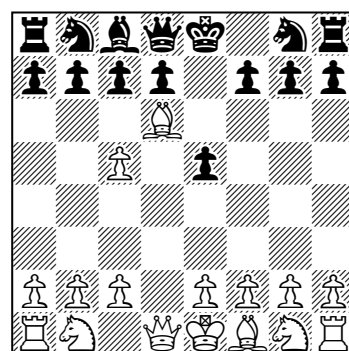
6) Win
1.Kb3! Nc7 2.d7
(1.Ka4/Kc4? K any 2.d7 Nb6+!)
(1.Ka3/Kc3? Nc7! 2.d7 Nb5+ 3.K any Kc7)



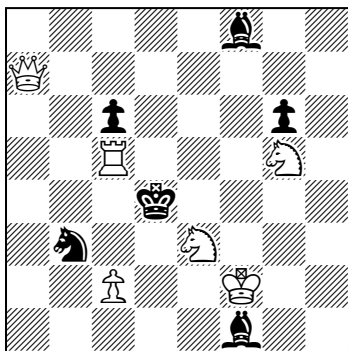
7) Mate in 2
Try: 1.Qf1? (threat 2.Nf6) but 1...Re1!
Key: 1.Nc1! (threat 2.Qg4)
1. ... Rf3 2.Qa4
1. ... Re2 2.Qd3



8) Draw
1.Rxd1 Ba2+ 2.Rd5 Bxd5+
3.Kh8 Rxa5 4.d8=B! Ra8 stalemate. (4.d8=Q/R? Ra8;
4.d8=N? g5) (1.d8=Q? Qxd5+ 2.Qxd5 Ba2 3.Kh8 Bxd5 4.a6 Re1 wins)

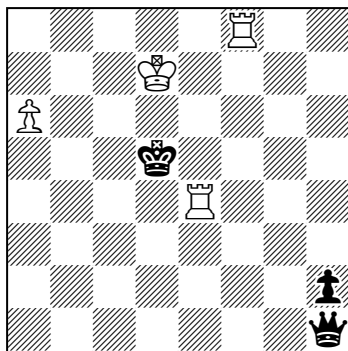


9) Proof game in 4.0 moves
1.d4 e6 2.Bf4 Ba3!
3.Bd6 Bc5 4.dxc5 e5.



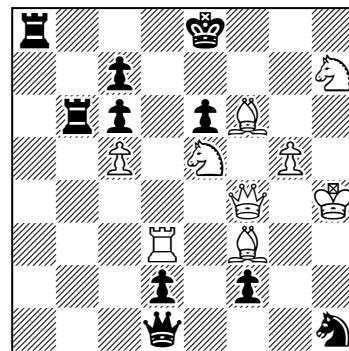
10) Mate in 2

1.Qb8! (threat 2.Qe5)
 1. ... Bxc5 2.Qh8
 1. ... Nxc5 2.Qb2
 1. ... Bg7/Bd6 2.Q(x)d6
 1. ... Kxc5 2.Ne6



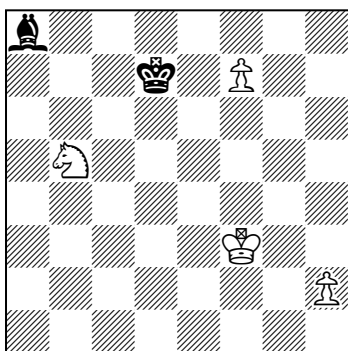
11) Win

1.a7 Qa1 2.a8=Q+ Qxa8
 3.Rxa8 h1=Q 4.Rh4!
 Qxh4 5.Ra5+.
 (1.Ref4? Kc5!)



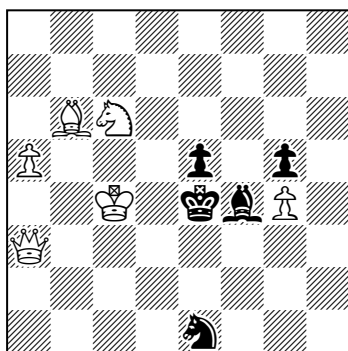
12) Mate in 2

1.Qd4? 1...Ra4!
 1.Qe4? 1...Rb4!
 1.Qg4? 1...Qa4!
 1.Qc4! threat 2.Qxe6
 1. ... Ra4 2.Rd8
 1. ... Rb4 2.Bxc6
 1. ... Qa4 2.Bh5
 1. ... Qb3 2.Bh5



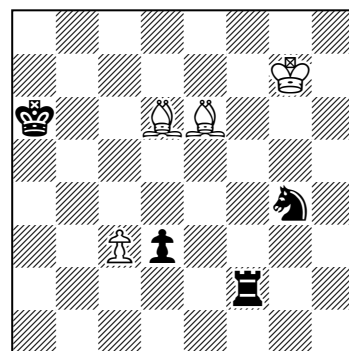
13) Win

1.Kf2! Ke7 2.Nc7 Bh1!
 3.Kg1 Bb7/Bc6 4.Ne6
 Kxf7 5.Nd8+
 (3...Be4/Bf3 4.Ne6 Kxf7
 5.Ng5+)



14) Mate in 3

1.Na7! waiting
 1...Bc1/Bd2 2.Qf8 Bf4
 3.Qa8#
 1...B else 2.Qe3#
 1...N any 2.Qd3#



15) Draw

1.Bc4+ Kb6 2.Bxd3 Rd2 3.Bf5
 Ne3 4.Bf4 Nxf5+ 5.Kf6 Rd5
 6.c4 Ra5 7.c5+ Rxc5 8.Be5!
 N any 9.Bd4 =
 (1...Kb7 2.Bxd3 Rd2 3.Be4+)
 (1...Ka5 2.Bb4+ any 3.Bxd3)

Authors

- 1) W.A.Shinkman, *Dubuque Chess Journal*, 1873
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- 4) L.Aliev, *Olimpiya dunyasi*, 2008 (version)
- 5) D.K.Kanonik, 1 Prize, Lokker MT, 1974
- 6) Y.Afek, 2005 (abbrev.)
- 7) V.Markovtsy, 3 Prize, *L'Italia Scacchistica*, 1999
- 8) N.Kralin, 2 Prize, Simhovic MT, 1995 (abbrev.)

- 9) B.Gadjanski, 4-5 Comm., Netanya Ty, 1999
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- 14) F.Healey, *The Illustrated London News*, 1864
- 15) G.Zachodjakin, COM, Spartak, 1962